



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Pronunciation Spot: Time for some professional development.



Learning Outcome

Describe characteristics of different people and their jobs.

Ask your partner:

- Do you ever take courses to help with your job?
- What are they? What do you learn in these courses?

Can Do Statements

- I can pronounce swallowed syllables.
- I can answer simple questions at work.
- I can identify key information in a short audio.





Let's Explore!

John is attending a professional development seminar. Who does he meet? Listen to their conversation.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

John: Hey, there.
Sandra: Oh, yes. Hi, John. Nice name tag.
John: So, you're here for the professional development seminar, too?
Sandra: Yes. I'm here every month. What department do you work in?
John: Actually, I just got back from the States. I've been giving tours.
Sandra: Interesting! A presentation on customer service would be useful in your career.
John: I'm not sure if I want to continue in the hospitality industry in the future.
Sandra: Why not?
John: It's a bit of a dead-end job.
Sandra: What is your ideal job then?
John: I'm still trying to figure that out. I need something different.
Sandra: Well, on that note, I'd better grab my folder.
John: Your folder?
Sandra: I'm Sandra Kingston, managing director at U.S. Tours and your guest speaker.



Let's Practice!

Ready to "swallow" your words and syllables?

Instructions: Practice reading the sentences aloud.

1. Every
2. I just got back from the States.
3. It's a bit of a dead-end job.
4. What department do you work in?
5. I'm not sure if I want to continue in the hospitality industry in the future.



Let's Practice!

Can you tell me the answer?

Instructions: Choose the correct answer.

- | | |
|--|---|
| <ol style="list-style-type: none"> 1. So, you're here for the professional development seminar. | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> ☐ Yes, I am here for the company dinner. ☐ Yes. I'm here every month. ☐ What do you do? |
| <ol style="list-style-type: none"> 2. What is your ideal job then? | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> ☐ I'm still trying to figure that out. ☐ I like to take lunch at 1 pm. ☐ I am finishing the report. |
| <ol style="list-style-type: none"> 3. Why not stay in the hospitality industry? | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> ☐ It's a bit of a dead-end job. ☐ Yes, the folders are on your desk. ☐ So, you're here for the professional development seminar too? |





Extension Activity

What is your ideal job?

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Choose your ideal job.
- List 5 skills you need to do the job.
- List 5 job responsibilities.
- How much are you paid per year?
- Share your answers with a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I make decisions about jobs and work.

☐ ☐

I write a list of 5 skills that I need for the job.

☐ ☐

I write a list of 5 job responsibilities.

☐ ☐

I express and say monetary numbers.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **name tag** (noun): a piece of paper, cloth, plastic, or metal that has a person's name written on it and that is attached to the person's clothing
e.g. I see you have a name tag on.
- **seminar** (noun): a meeting in which you receive information on and training in a particular subject
e.g. We are going to the customer service seminar today.
- **presentation** (noun): an activity in which someone shows, describes, or explains something to a group of people
e.g. She gave a fantastic presentation.
- **hospitality** (adjective): providing food, drinks and care to people who are customers of an organization
Example: John works in the hospitality industry.
- **dead end job** (expression): a job with no future
e.g. I don't want to work in a dead end job.
- **to figure that out** (expression): to decide on something
Example: I'm still trying to figure that out.
- **guest speaker** (expression): a person who is invited to talk to a group of people
e.g. Sandra is the guest speaker at the seminar.
- **on that note** (expression): to move on to another, less unpleasant subject
e.g. On that note, I'd better grab my folder.





Learning Points

Swallowed Syllables

Non-stressed words and syllables are often "swallowed" in English.

Key words like nouns, pronouns, verbs or adjectives are stressed and other words like articles and prepositions are shortened and weakened ("swallowed"). Syllables in words can also be "swallowed".

Two or three swallowed words can take up the same amount of time as one stressed syllable before or after it.

For example:

I like walking in the park,

The syllables *I / like / wal / park*, are stressed.

The 3 syllables *kin / in / the*, are said much faster and blend together.

Remember:

Focus on pronouncing stressed words well, non-stressed words are weaker and swallowed. Focus on the stressed words in each sentence.

Answering Simple Questions at Work

You are often asked simple questions at work like:

Question	Possible Answer Example
What are you working on?	<i>I am finishing the report.</i>
When do you take lunch?	<i>I have lunch at 1 p.m.</i>
Are you planning on leaving soon?	<i>I'm going to leave in ten minutes.</i>
Did the client call?	<i>She called yesterday afternoon.</i>
When is the meeting?	<i>The meeting is after the presentation.</i>
Did you complete the tasks?	<i>Yes, the folders are on your desk.</i>
Who do you work for?	<i>I've been working on a cruise ship.</i>